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More forms

Reset Buttons

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```
Name: <input type="text" name="name" /> <br />
Food: <input type="text" name="meal" value="pizza" />
<br />
<label>Meat? <input type="checkbox" name="meat" /></label>
<br />
<input type="reset" />
```

HTML

Name:

Food:

Meat? ☐

- specify custom text on the button by setting its value attribute

Grouping input: <fieldset>, <legend>

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```
<fieldset>
  <legend>Credit cards:</legend>
  <input type="radio" name="cc" value="visa"
checked="checked" /> Visa
  <input type="radio" name="cc" value="mastercard" />
  MasterCard
  <input type="radio" name="cc" value="amex" />
  American Express
</fieldset>
```

HTML

- fieldset groups related input fields, adds a border; legend supplies a caption

Common UI control errors

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- “I changed the form's HTML code ... but when I refresh, the page doesn't update!”
- By default, when you refresh a page, it leaves the previous values in all form controls
 - it does this in case you were filling out a long form and needed to refresh/return to it
 - if you want it to clear out all UI controls' state and values, you must do a full refresh
 - Firefox: Shift-Ctrl-R
 - Mac: Shift-Command-R

Styling form controls

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```
input[type="text"] {  
    background-color: yellow;  
    font-weight: bold;  
}  
CSS
```

- attribute selector: matches only elements that have a particular attribute value
- useful for controls because many share the same element (input)

Hidden input parameters

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```
<input type="text" name="username" /> Name <br />  
<input type="text" name="sid" /> SID <br />  
<input type="hidden" name="school" value="UW" />  
<input type="hidden" name="year" value="2048" />
```

HTML

- an invisible parameter that is still passed to the server when form is submitted
- useful for passing on additional state that isn't modified by the user

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Submitting data

Problems with submitting data

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```
<form action="http://localhost/test1.php" method="get">
<label><input type="radio" name="cc" /> Visa</label>
<label><input type="radio" name="cc" /> MasterCard</label>
<br />
Favorite Star Trek captain:
<select name="startrek">
    <option>James T. Kirk</option>
    <option>Jean-Luc Picard</option>
</select> <br />
</form>
```

HTML

- the form may look correct, but when you submit it...
- **[cc] => on**, [startrek] => Jean-Luc Picard

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How can we resolve this conflict?

The value attribute

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```
<label><input type="radio" name="cc" value="visa" />
Visa</label>
<label><input type="radio" name="cc" value="mastercard" />
MasterCard</label> <br />
Favorite Star Trek captain:
<select name="startrek">
    <option value="kirk">James T. Kirk</option>
    <option value="picard">Jean-Luc Picard</option>
<input type="submit" value="submit" />
</select> <br />
```

HTML

- value attribute sets what will be submitted if a control is selected
- [cc] => visa, [startrek] => picard

URL-encoding

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- certain characters are not allowed in URL query parameters:
 - examples: " ", "/", "=", "&"
- when passing a parameter, it is URL-encoded
 - "Xenia's cool!?" → "Xenia%27s+cool%3F%21"
- you don't usually need to worry about this:
 - the browser automatically encodes parameters before sending them
 - the PHP \$_REQUEST array automatically decodes them
 - ... but occasionally the encoded version does

Submitting data to a web server

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- though browsers mostly retrieve data, sometimes you want to submit data to a server
 - Hotmail: Send a message
 - Flickr: Upload a photo
 - Google Calendar: Create an appointment
- the data is sent in HTTP requests to the server
 - with HTML forms
 - with **Ajax** (seen later)
- the data is placed into the request as parameters

HTTP GET vs. POST requests

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- GET : asks a server for a page or data
 - if the request has parameters, they are sent in the URL as a query string
- POST : submits data to a web server and retrieves the server's response
 - if the request has parameters, they are embedded in the request's HTTP packet, not the URL

HTTP GET vs. POST requests

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- For submitting data, a POST request is more appropriate than a GET
 - GET requests embed their parameters in their URLs
 - URLs are limited in length (~ 1024 characters)
 - URLs cannot contain special characters without encoding
 - private data in a URL can be seen or modified by users

Form POST example

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```
<form action="http://localhost/app.php" method="post">
<div>
    Name: <input type="text" name="name" /> <br />
    Food: <input type="text" name="meal" /> <br />
    <label>Meat? <input type="checkbox" name="meat"
/></label> <br />
    <input type="submit" />
</div>
</form>
```

HTML

GET or POST?

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```
if ($_SERVER["REQUEST_METHOD"] == "GET") {  
    # process a GET request  
    ...  
} elseif ($_SERVER["REQUEST_METHOD"] == "POST") {  
    # process a POST request  
    ...  
}
```

PHP

- some PHP pages process both GET and POST requests
- to find out which kind of request we are currently processing, look at the global `$_SERVER` array's "REQUEST_METHOD" element

Uploading files

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```
<form action="http://webster.cs.washington.edu/params.php"
method="post" enctype="multipart/form-data">
    Upload an image as your avatar:
    <input type="file" name="avatar" />
    <input type="submit" />
</form>
```

HTML

- add a file upload to your form as an input tag with type of file
- must also set the enctype attribute of the form

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Processing form data in PHP

"Superglobal" arrays

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Array	Description
<u>\$ REQUEST</u>	parameters passed to any type of request
<u>\$ GET</u> , <u>\$ POST</u>	parameters passed to GET and POST requests
<u>\$ SERVER</u> , <u>\$ ENV</u>	information about the web server
<u>\$ FILES</u>	files uploaded with the web request
<u>\$ SESSION</u> , <u>\$ COOKIE</u>	"cookies" used to identify the user (seen later)

- These are special kinds of arrays called associative arrays.

Associative arrays

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```
$blackbook = array();  
$blackbook["xenia"] = "206-685-2181";  
$blackbook["anne"] = "206-685-9138";  
...  
print "Xenia's number is " . $blackbook["xenia"] . ".\n";
```

PHP

- associative array (a.k.a. map, dictionary, hash table) : uses non-integer indexes
- associates a particular index "key" with a value
 - key "xenia" maps to value "206-685-2181"

\$_REQUEST

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- The **\$_REQUEST** superglobal contains data from submitted forms, URL query strings, and HTTP cookies.
- In other words, the **\$_REQUEST** superglobal is an array containing data from **\$_GET**, **\$_POST**, and **\$_COOKIE** superglobals.
- You access the data with the **\$_REQUEST** keyword followed by the name of the form field, query parameter, or cookie.

Example: exponents

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```
<?php
    $result = 0;
    if ($_SERVER["REQUEST_METHOD"] == "POST") {
        $base = $_REQUEST["base"];
        $exp = $_REQUEST["exponent"];
        $result = pow($base, $exp);
    } else {
        $result = "Logical error";
    }
?>
<body>
    <form action="<?php $_SERVER["PHP_SELF"] ?>" method="post">
        Base:
        <input type="number" name="base" id="base"><br><br>
        Exponent:
        <input type="number" name="exponent" id="exponent"><br>
        <input type="submit" value="Submit" name="submit">
    </form><br><br>
    <h2><?= $base ?> ^ <?= $exp ?> = <?= $result ?></h2>
</body>
```

PHP

Example: Print all parameters

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```
<form method="POST">
    Name:
    <input type="text" name="name"><br><br>
    Age:
    <input type="text" name="age"><br><br>
    Course:
    <input type="text" name="course"><br><br>
    <input type="submit" value="Submit">
</form>
<?php
    if (!empty($_REQUEST)) {
        foreach ($_REQUEST as $param => $value) {
            $safeParam = htmlspecialchars($param);
            $safeValue = htmlspecialchars($value);
            echo "<p>Parameter <strong>$safeParam</strong> has
value <strong>$safeValue</strong></p>";
        }
    } else {
        echo "<p>No parameters submitted yet.</p>";
    }
?>
```

PHP

Processing an uploaded file in PHP

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- uploaded files are placed into global array `$_FILES`, not `$_REQUEST`
- each element of `$_FILES` is itself an associative array, containing:
 - `name`: the local filename that the user uploaded
 - `type`: the MIME type of data that was uploaded, such as image/jpeg
 - `size`: file's size in bytes
 - `tmp_name`: a filename where PHP has temporarily saved the uploaded file
 - to permanently store the file, move it from this location into some other file

Uploading files

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```
<input type="file" name="avatar" />
```

HTML

- example: if you upload tobbby.jpg as a parameter named avatar,
 - \$_FILES["avatar"]["name"] will be "tobbbby.jpg"
 - \$_FILES["avatar"]["type"] will be "image/jpeg"
 - \$_FILES["avatar"]["tmp_name"] will be something like "/var/tmp/phpZtR4TI"


```
Array
(
    [file1] => Array
        (
            [name] => MyFile.txt (comes from the browser,
so treat as tainted)
            [type] => text/plain (not sure where it gets
this from - assume the browser, so treat as tainted)
            [tmp_name] => /tmp/php/php1h4j1o (could be
anywhere on your system, depending on your config
settings, but the user has no control, so this isn't
tainted)
            [error] => UPLOAD_ERR_OK (= 0)
            [size] => 123 (the size in bytes)
        )
    [file2] => Array
        (
            [name] => MyFile.jpg
            [type] => image/jpeg
            [tmp_name] => /tmp/php/php6hst32
            [error] => UPLOAD_ERR_OK
            [size] => 98174
        )
)
```

Processing uploaded file example

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```
$username = $_REQUEST["username"];  
if (is_uploaded_file($_FILES["avatar"]["tmp_name"])) {  
    move_uploaded_file($_FILES["avatar"]["tmp_name"],  
        "$username/avatar.jpg");  
    print "Saved uploaded file as $username/avatar.jpg\  
n";  
} else {  
    print "Error: required file not uploaded";  
}  
PHP
```

- `is_uploaded_file(filename)`
returns TRUE if the given filename was uploaded by the user
- `move_uploaded_file(from, to)`
moves from a temporary file location to a more permanent file

Including files: `include`

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```
include("header.php");
```

PHP

- inserts the entire contents of the given file into the PHP script's output page
- encourages modularity
- useful for defining reused functions needed by multiple pages